

Sharing the fortune

There are many reasons why some countries have remained poor while others have prospered. Some are rich in natural resources and others benefitted from being home to inventions of new technology. Many rich countries recognize they've been lucky and see it as their duty to share their good fortune with poorer countries. Individuals give to charities that provide food and clean water to the poor. Governments in the developed world often set aside a percentage of the money from taxpayers to provide foreign aid, and together support international institutions like the World Bank, which provides financial help for projects in developing countries. Many businesses donate to charity or invest in industry overseas.